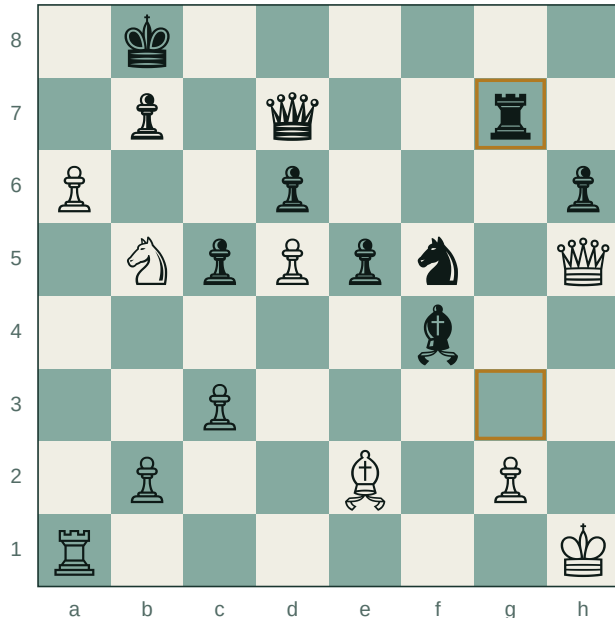


Double checks: White, move 29

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 28...Rg7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. a7+ Ka8 30. Nc7+ Qxc7 31. Qe8+ Qb8 32. axb8=Q#

29.a7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29...Ka8**.

30.Nc7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **30...Qxc7**.

31.Qe8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **31...Qb8**.

32.axb8=Q# Mate: rook on a1 and queen on b8 give check; Black has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a1 and queen on b8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on b8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.